

ent Survey Action Issue that links to the division wide epic. In the Issue, managers can link team wide actions to the division.

FY24 Division-Wide Engagement Survey Action Epics

- Product
- Engineering
- Sales
- Marketing
- Finance
- People
- Legal & Corporate Affairs
- CISO

Summit Pulse Surveys Overview

The goal of the Summit is to build trust through social connections. This trust should lead to higher individual and team motivation, leading to higher productivity and retention. Higher trust between individuals and teams fuels collaboration and leads to stronger results.

To best determine how effective we are at achieving the goal of Summit is to gauge team member perceptions before and after the event.

We ran two surveys

- Pre-Summit: January 9, 2024 to January 19, 2024
- Post-Summit: March 15, 2024 to April 5, 2024

This will helped us gain valuable insights into any shifts in sentiments among team members, allowing us to assess the true impact of the summit, satisfaction and engagement.

This is an abbreviated version of our engagement survey, and it also includes a few Summit related questions.

Survey Confidentiality

In an effort to ensure team member confidentiality is upheld, only managers with >5 respondents will be able to view quantitative results - this is carried across to demographic filtering in teams with population sizes which exceed the minimum too. The survey is wholly administered by Culture Amp on a secure external website and the survey data will not be stored on any local computer. If you'd like to know more, check out CultureAmp's FAQ guide.

Survey Results

Team members can access Summit Pulse Survey results [here](#)

FY'23 Pulse Engagement Survey

FY'23 Pulse Engagement Survey Timeline

- 2022-05-16: Pulse Survey launch

- 2022-05-25: Pulse Survey close
- 2022-06-14: Results shared with e-group
- 2022-06-21: Managers with 5+ responses receive reports via Culture Amp
- 2022-06-21 through 2022-07-04: Leaders/Managers review their reports and discuss/brainstorm action plans in Staff/team meetings
- 2022-06-28 and 2022-06-29: Results shared company-wide at GitLab Assembly
- 2022-07-30: Finalize Action items and document in epics/issues
- 2022-08-01: Functional action plans added to FY'23 Q3 OKRs and Division epics

Taking Action

Once the GitLab Team Member Engagement Survey has been closed out, reports will be disseminated to the E-Group and Divisional Heads for review i.e. only those with team populations >5. These will form the basis of discussion when collaboratively compiling the people strategy for year ahead in conjunction with additional data such as attrition reports etc.

Timeline for Action Planning

- Each E-Group member will in collaboration with their respective People Business Partner (PBP) to identify one or two action items to initiate coming out of the results review - these will be tracked and managed via a dedicated Epic in GitLab per Division.
- After action items have been identified at the E-Group level, all managers who received an engagement survey result report (AKA: managers with 5+ direct reports who responded to the survey) will also be asked to create an action plan in Culture Amp.
- A manager may choose to align their action planning to their leader or division or they may choose to add a specific and separate action for their team. This will likely depend on the size/structure of the organization.

Using Epics and Issues to Create an Action Plan

For the FY23 Engagement Survey, all divisions are recommended to create an Epic to store Engagement Survey Action Issues. Every Division should create an Epic that gives an overview of the engagement survey results that includes: highlights, lowlights, recommended actions, and resources. Epic's can be created in division issue boards or projects that are applicable to the organization.

In addition, Managers can create an Engagement Survey Action Issue that links to the division wide epic. In the Issue, managers can link team wide actions to the division.

See the example epics from FY22 for inspiration.

FY23 Division-Wide Engagement Survey Action Epics

- Engineering
- Product
- Sales
- Marketing
- Finance
- People

- Legal & Corporate Affairs

Resources for Managers

Engagement Survey Manager Toolkit - GitLab Learn pathway

Managers Guide to Taking Action

Take Action with Action Framework

FY'23 Q2 Pulse Engagement Survey Results

Our Pulse Engagement Survey FY'23 Q2 ran from 2022-05-16 to 2022-05-25. The survey was opened to team members hired before 2022-04-30.

1. We reached 82% participation and an overall engagement score of 81% favorable.

1. We scored 4% lower than we did in the FY'22 Q4 Engagement Survey overall, but this score is still 8% higher than our New Tech peer group, which consists of ~150 fast growing and disruptive tech companies who have ~1000+ total team members.

1. Amongst our SaaS Talent Peers of 1000+ team members - engagement scores are decreasing by 5-10% from pre to during-pandemic times.

1. GitLab remains industry-leading from a scoring perspective.

Below you will find a summary of our overall results, as well as key insights and opportunities.

A huge thanks to everyone who completed the survey and made their voice heard. Your feedback helps us to continually improve the experience of working at GitLab.

Company Results (Overall)

Favourable Neutral Unfavourable
----- ----- -----
81% 13% 6%

Top Three Scores

In addition to Engagement, we asked questions about other factors regarding our workplace and culture. A factor score is the average score of all questions within that factor.

Factor Favourability Rating
----- -----
Your Manager 87%
Inclusion 82%
Growth & Development 81%

GitLab was rated between 5%-8% percent higher than the industry benchmark i.e. New Tech (1,000+) 2022 across all three factors detailed above.

Question Favourability Rating

Factor	Favourability Rating
I am proud to work for GitLab	94%
I would recommend GitLab as a great place to work	91%
My manager keeps me informed about what is happening	90%

GitLab was rated between 6-8% higher than the industry benchmark i.e. New Tech (1,000+) 2022 across all three questions detailed above.

Top Three Opportunities

Factor	Favourability Rating
Action	59%
Your Role	70%
Our Leaders	77%

GitLab was rated up to 3% higher than the industry benchmark i.e. New Tech (1,000+) 2022.

Question	Favourability Rating
I have seen positive changes taking place based on recent team member survey results	54%
I believe my Compensation (Base, Bonus, etc.) is competitive relative to similar roles at other companies	62%
I believe action will take place as a result of this survey	64%

GitLab scored 4% higher than the industry benchmark i.e. New Tech +1,000 2022 for the lowest scoring question surrounding positive actions, 9% higher than the benchmark regarding compensation and 2% higher regarding actions taken from the survey.

FY'22 Pulse Engagement Survey

How We Determine "Pulse" Survey Questions

In FY'22 Q4 we launched our first "pulse" survey. To determine these questions we leveraged a combination of Culture Amp's "impact" feature + recommended focus areas + key themes related to the Great Resignation (according to Culture Amp's People Scientist teams) to determine which rating questions to include in the pulse survey.

Per CultureAmp's insights related to the Great Resignation, we added questions related to:

- Focus on "Your Manager" (feedback from Manager, and overall manager performance)
- Inclusion
- The 5 overall Engagement factor questions

Culture Amp determines which questions are "focus recommendations" based on: impact on overall, favorable score, comparison to benchmarks. Here is more information on how Culture Amp determines "focus" recommendations.

"Impact" is a word we use to refer to a statistical technique called a driver analysis. People Intelligence relies on a lot of data and analysis techniques, and one of the most powerful is

Driver Analysis. Driver Analysis lets you focus on the most important drivers of outcomes for your culture. The questions that are identified as the top drivers are the questions that are most likely having the biggest impact on Engagement (or whatever measure you have set up as your outcome). So if you were able to improve your scores on these questions, you are likely to improve your Engagement score. You can find more information on how "impact" is determined [here](#).

In addition to leveraging insights from our Engagement Survey tool, Culture Amp, the People Group may add in a couple of additional questions particularly relevant to current business priorities, changes, and/or challenges.

FY'22 Pulse Engagement Survey Questions

The FY'22 Pulse Engagement Survey included 19 rating questions and 3 open ended text questions. A complete list of questions can be found [here](#).

FY'22 Pulse Engagement Survey Timeline

- 2021-11-04: Pulse Survey launch @ 8am PT
- 2021-11-18: Pulse Survey close @ 11pm PT
- 2021-11-22: High-level summary shared with CPO and PBPs
- 2021-11-29: High-level summary shared with e-group
- 2021-12-01: High-level summary release (company-wide)
- 2021-12-03: E-group division-level summary release
- 2021-12-08: Training video (updated as needed) and results handbook update
- 2021-12-10 through 2021-12-31: Functional group action planning
- 2022-01-31: Functional action plans added to FY'23 Q1 OKRs and Division epics

Note: Only team members hired on or before October 15, 2021 will be eligible to participate in the Pulse Engagement Survey.

Taking Action

Once the GitLab Team Member Engagement Survey has been closed out, reports will be disseminated to the E-Group and Divisional Heads for review i.e. only those with team populations >5. These will form the basis of discussion when collaboratively compiling the people strategy for year ahead in conjunction with additional data such as attrition reports etc.

Timeline for Action Planning

- Each E-Group member will in collaboration with their respective People Business Partner (PBP) to identify one or two action items to initiate coming out of the results review - these will be tracked and managed within CultureAmp moving forward using the Action Framework.
- After action items have been identified at the E-Group level, all managers who received an engagement survey result report (AKA: managers with 5+ direct reports who responded to the survey) will also be asked to create an action plan in Culture Amp.
- A manager may choose to align their action planning to their leader or division or they may choose to add a specific and separate action for their team. This will likely depend on the size/structure of the organization.

Using Epics and Issues to Create an Action Plan

For the FY22 Engagement Survey, all divisions are recommended to create an Epic to store Engagement Survey Action Issues. Every Division should create an Epic that gives an overview of the engagement survey results that includes: highlights, lowlights, recommended actions, and resources. Epic's can be created in division issue boards or projects that are applicable to the organization.

In addition, Managers can create an Engagement Survey Action Issue that links to the division wide epic. In the Issue, managers can link team wide actions to the division.

See the examples from FY21' for the Product and Development groups for inspiration.

FY22 Division-Wide Engagement Survey Action Epics:

- Engineering
- Product
- Sales
- Marketing
- Finance
- People
- Legal & Corporate Affairs

Resources for Managers

Engagement Survey Manager Toolkit - GitLab Learn pathway

Managers Guide to Taking Action

Take Action with Action Framework

FY' 22 Q4 Pulse Engagement Survey Results

Our Pulse Engagement Survey FY'22 Q4 ran from 2021-11-4 to 2021-11-18 and was open to all team members who started prior to 2021-10-15. We reached 87% participation and an overall engagement score of 85% favorable.

This score is 9 pts higher than our New Tech peer group, which consists of ~150 fast growing and disruptive tech companies who have ~1000+ total team members.

We also scored 4 pts higher than we did in the 2020 Engagement Survey overall.

Below you will find a summary of our overall results, as well as key insights and opportunities.

A huge thanks to everyone who completed the survey and made their voice heard. Your feedback helps us to continually improve the experience of working at GitLab.

Company Results (Overall)

Favourable	Neutral	Unfavourable

| 85% | 11% | 4% |

Top Three Scores

In addition to Engagement, we asked questions about other factors regarding our workplace and culture. A factor score is the average score of all questions within that factor.

Factor	Favourability Rating
Company Confidence	94%
Inclusion	88%
Our Leaders	83%

GitLab was rated between 4%-12% percent higher than the industry benchmark i.e. New Tech (1,000+) 2021 across all three factors detailed above.

Question	Favourability Rating
I am proud to work for GitLab	96%
GitLab is in a position to really succeed over the next three years	94%
I would recommend GitLab as a great place to work	94%

GitLab was rated between 7-12% percent higher than the industry benchmark i.e. New Tech (1,000+) 2021 across all three questions detailed above.

Top Three Opportunities

Factor	Favourability Rating
Action	55%
Your Role	67%
Growth & Development	79%

GitLab was rated between 1%-10% percent higher than the industry benchmark i.e. New Tech (1,000+) 2021 across all three factors detailed above.

Question	Favourability Rating
I have seen positive changes taking place based on recent team member survey results	48%
I believe action will take place as a result of this survey	61%
I believe there are good career opportunities for me at GitLab	72%

GitLab scored 1-2% below the industry benchmark i.e. New Tech +1,000 2021 for the two lowest scoring questions surrounding positive actions however GitLab scored 6% higher than the benchmark regarding career opportunities.

FY' 22 E-Group Focus Areas

For the FY'22 Q4 Pulse Engagement Survey results, we will be leaning into epics and issues for tracking and planning.

You can find full detail on the process and guidance [here](#).

All links should be added by 2022-01-21 aligned with our timeline.

Actions taken since the last survey

Growth & Development

- 1. 2 L&D team members trained to deliver Crucial Conversations and so far delivered 3 cohorts in 2021
- 1. Hosted multiple live learning sessions
- 1. Organized Skill of the Month
- 1. Added LinkedIn Learning benefit for team members
- 1. Iterated and delivered multiple sessions of Manager Challenge
- 1. Implemented new GitLab Learn LXP
- 1. Built out mentorship handbook resources
- 1. Piloting LifeLabs Learning for Manager Enablement
- 1. Launched GitLab Team Members Certification
- 1. Learning & Development Team expansion with 2 new team members
- 1. Facilitated over 15 CEO Handbook Learning Sessions
- 1. Launched Functional Learning Hubs on GitLab Learn

Compensation

- 1. Implemented regions in the location factors.
- 1. Moved to annual refresh grants from 3.5 year refresh with the first cycle taking effect March 2021.
- 1. Moved from options to RSUs in September 2021.
- 1. Reduced the vesting for RSUs to new hire cliff of 6 months and no cliff for promos/refresh.
- 1. Implemented industry leading ESPP / Alternate ESPP for all team members at GitLab.

Resource Allocation

- 1. Increased headcount from 1267 team members in December 2020 to 1574 team members in December 2021.
- 1. Our average promotion rate in 2021 is 16.77%, which is higher than the average market promotion rate

Questions and Support

The GitLab Team Member Engagement Survey is managed by the People Connect Team. If you require support or have any questions around the survey please be sure to reach out via HelpLab.

Previous Engagement Survey Results

FY' 21 Engagement Survey

The GitLab Team Member Engagement Survey for 2020 (FY21) ran from 2020-11-16 to 2020-12-15 - questions and fine details can be found in the following planning issue.

Bar those who joined on or after 2020-11-01 the survey was extended to all GitLab Team members for completion. Participation for the FY21 survey closed out at 92% with 1,127 team members having taken part.

Benchmarking and Reporting

The FY21 survey was benchmarked against New Tech 1,000+ 2020 in addition to being reviewed against the preceding years results. Preliminary reports were released on 2021-01-08 painting a broad overview afterwhich individual divisional reviews will take place in collaboration with the People Business Partners (PBPs) and respective Group Leaders.

Company Results (Overall)

Favourable	Neutral	Unfavourable
81%	14%	5%

The benchmarked favourability score for New Tech 1,000+ 2020 was 73% placing GitLab 8% higher than the norm for this particular bracket.

Top Three Scores

Factor	Favourability Rating
Your Manager	88%
Well-being COVID-19	85%
Culture	84%
Question	Favourability Rating
-----	-----
I am proud to work for GitLab	93%
I feel supported when I need to take time off or make use of flexible working arrangements	93%
I know how my work contributes to the goals of GitLab	93%

GitLab was rated between 5-13% percent higher than the industry benchmark i.e. New Tech +1,000 2020 across all three questions detailed above.

Bottom Three Scores

Factor	Favourability Rating
Our Leaders	79%
Growth & Development	70%
Action	54%
Question	Favourability Rating
-----	-----
I have been provided an opportunity to see and discuss prior engagement survey results	60%
The Learning & Development programs provided by GitLab help me grow my career	47%
I have seen positive changes since the previous engagement survey	39%

GitLab scored 5% below the industry benchmark i.e. New Tech +1,000 2020 for the lowest scoring question surrounding positive changes however there was no comparative for the other two questions.

FY' 21 E-Group Focus Areas

- Action (though action is our lowest score we have seen improvement year over year and will continue to focus on this area)
- Growth & Development
- Compensation
- Resource Allocations

Questions and Support

The GitLab Team Member Engagement Survey is managed by the People Connect Team. If you require support or have any questions around the survey please be sure to reach out via HelpLab.

FY' 20 Engagement Survey

The GitLab Team Member Engagement Survey for 2019 (FY20) ran from 2019-10-14 to 2019-11-04 - questions and fine details can be found in the following planning issue.

Bar those who joined on or after 2019-10-01 the survey was extended to all GitLab Team members for completion. Participation for the FY20 survey closed out at 87% with 812 team members having taken part.

Benchmarking and Reporting

The FY20 survey was benchmarked against New Tech Size >500 2019 in addition to being reviewed against the preceding years results. Preliminary reports were released in the week of 2019-11-07 painting a broad overview afterwhich individual divisional reviews will take place in collaboration with the People Business Partners (PBPs) and respective Group Leaders.

Company Results (Overall)

Favourable Neutral Unfavourable
----- ----- -----
88% 9% 3%

A benchmarked favourability score for New Tech Size >500 2019 was not available for this particular survey.

Top Three Scores

Factor Favourability Rating
----- -----
Culture 87%
Your Manager 87%
Teamwork 86%
Question Favourability Rating

| ----- | ----- |
 | I would recommend GitLab as a great place to work | 95% |
 | GitLab is in a position to really succeed over the next three years | 94% |
 | I am proud to work for GitLab | 94% |

GitLab was rated between 11-17% higher than the industry benchmark i.e. New Tech Size >500 2019 across all three questions detailed above.

Bottom Three Scores

Factor	Favourability Rating
Your Role	84%
Growth & Development	80%
Action	46%
Question	Favourability Rating
-----	-----
I believe action will take place as a result of this survey	64%
I have been provided an opportunity to see and discuss prior engagement survey results	46%
I have seen positive changes since the previous engagement survey	29%

GitLab scored 15% below the industry benchmark i.e. New Tech Size >500 2019 for the lowest scoring question surrounding positive changes however there was no comparative for the other two questions.

FY' 20 E-Group Focus Areas

- Taking action from areas guided by the GitLab Team Member Engagement Survey Results.
- Managerial encouragement of Team Member development.
- Total Compensation.

FY' 19 Engagement Survey

The GitLab Team Member Engagement Survey for 2018 (FY19) ran from 2018-10-14 to 2018-11-04 - questions and fine details can be found in the following planning issue.

Bar those who joined on or after 2018-08-17 the survey was extended to all GitLab Team members for completion. Participation for the FY19 survey closed out at 94% with 308 team members having taken part.

Benchmarking and Reporting

The FY19 survey was benchmarked against 2018 New Tech Size - Large Companies (500+). Preliminary reports were released in the week of 2018-11-06 painting a broad overview afterwhich individual divisional reviews will take place in collaboration with the People Business Partners (PBPs) and respective Group Leaders.

Company Results (Overall)

Favourable	Neutral	Unfavourable
83%	12%	5%

The benchmarked favourability score for 2018 New Tech Size - Large Companies (500+) was noted at 70% i.e. 13% lower than that of GitLab overall.

Top Scoring Factors

Factor	Favourability Rating
Company Confidence	84%
Management	84%
Collaboration and Communication	84%
Work / Life Balance	84%
Question	Favourability Rating
I am proud to work for GitLab	95%
I know how my work contributes to the goals of GitLab	94%
GitLab is really in a position to succeed over the next three years	93%

GitLab was rated between 4-14% percent higher than the industry benchmark i.e. 2018 New Tech Size - Large Companies (500+) across all three questions detailed above.

Bottom Three Scores

Factor	Favourability Rating
Alignment and Involvement	74%
Feedback and Recognition	63%
Action	41%
Question	Favourability Rating
I believe my total compensation (base salary+any bonus+benefits+equity) is fair relative to similar roles at other companies	43%
My manager or someone else has communicated clear actions based on recent team member survey results	33%
I have seen positive changes taking place based on recent employee survey results	32%

GitLab scored 12% below the industry benchmark i.e. 2018 New Tech Size - Large Companies (500+) for the lowest scoring question surrounding positive changes however there was no comparative for the other two questions.

FY' 19 E-Group Focus Areas

- Taking action from areas guided by the GitLab Team Member Engagement Survey Results.
- Managerial encouragement of Team Member development.
- Total Compensation.

People Operations Procedures

How to add sub-departments or other demographics not found in Workday

1. Open CultureAmp > Settings > Data Intergrations
1. Select the blue Sync Data button
1. Select Partial Upload
1. Click on Export Users > Export
1. Update the information on the spreadsheet
1. Upload the spreadsheet into CultureAmp
1. Select Next (bottom right corner)
 - If you select Sync it will only Sync with Workday, regardless if you uploaded a file.
1. Select Import Data

You have now updated a demographic in CultureAmp!

</details>

<details>

<summary>Organizational Health Surveys</summary>

In Q3 FY'23, our Talent & Engagement team ran our first organizational health survey.

GitLab used McKinsey & Company's Organizational Health Index "OHI" survey to help us understand where we have opportunities to help our organization and team members execute better and increase their impact. The OHI survey is separate from our CultureAmp Engagement survey; learnings from the former will complement the latter and also help inform workplace practices beyond GitLab.

FY'23 Q3/Q4 McKinsey OHI Survey Results

We've summarized high level results of the OHI survey for all GitLab team members in this document.

The document linked above is only available to GitLab team members.

SECTION: people-group/frequent-requests.md

Kindly note that the Frequently Requested Page has been migrated to the Internal Handbook and this page will soon be removed.

SECTION: people-group/givelab-volunteer-initiatives.md

About GiveLab

GiveLab is GitLab's Team Member Volunteer Program. The GiveLab Program lives under the ESG Team and is a part of GitLab's overall ESG strategy and program development. The term GiveLab encompasses all Team Member Volunteering initiatives at GitLab.

GitLab encourages team members to take part in volunteer initiatives that support their local communities, participate in virtual volunteer activities, and organize volunteer activities as part of team events and get together.

To learn more about GiveLab, please visit the [ESG handbook page](#).

Historical GiveLab and Related Activities

GitLab Donation Drives

The first GitLab Donation Drive in 2020 started as an internal challenge to GitLab team members to donate 5,000 meals to US Food Banks over the course of a week. This initiative quickly gained traction and saw over 100,000 meals being donated across 19 countries. 2021's campaign expanded to include any type of donation, including donations of time as part of Global Volunteer Month.

Upstream Diversity Working Group

Having identified a talent gap in both the technology and the university system which speaks predominantly to Underrepresented Groups, the Upstream Diversity Working Group was established.

Geared toward knowledge sharing, the 2022 piloted program saw GitLab team members extending their technical skills and time to those in Underrepresented Groups (URGs) with a view to creating future career opportunities for them within the technology sector. The program mobilised GitLab team members to serve as coaches in partnership with Latinitas; FreeCodeCamp and re:Learn.

Trusted Interns

As a pioneer in the all-remote space, GitLab is uniquely leveraged to prepare youth around the globe for the future of work. Recently, GitLab Alumni Jean du Plessis, in collaboration with Trusted Interns as part of The Knowledge Trust which places a focus on making jobs more accessible to South African Youth, presented a webinar around Preparing for your First Remote Job.

This was a springboard for around 650 South African Youth from within the Trusted Interns program to complete the GitLab All-Remote Certification.

Rails Girls

On multiple occasions, GitLab has supported Rails Girls an organisation geared toward providing tools and creating a sense of community for women in the technology space - enabling them to grow their knowledge base and build out their ideas. The most recent event supported was the Rails Girls Kumasi Ruby on Rails Workshop - be sure to check out this [GitLab Unfiltered video](#) to see GitLab alumni Abubakar Siddiq Ango in action!

Recent Team Member Participation

GitLab encourages team members to set time aside to take part in local volunteer initiatives within their respective communities. Here are a few of the of projects our team members have

lent hands or resources to of late:

Operation Warm providing warmth, confidence and hope to children in need through the gift of brand-new winter coats. Over the last 20 years, Operation Warm and our partners have used the coat as a bridge for families in need to access everything from flu shots to new books.

Fontanus Research Center which aims to create new, efficient and interdisciplinary educational methodologies.

National Charity League a multi-generational philanthropic organization of mother and daughters who volunteer close to three million hours annually to over 6,000 charities in the United States.

Hack for She, a completely virtual hackathon aimed to find solutions to Women's problems.

Return to the People Group Handbook.

SECTION: people-group/guidance-on-feedback.md

Giving and receiving feedback is an important part of building strong relationships and high performing teams. Feedback aligns to GitLab values in the following ways:

- 1. Collaboration: Forms strong and trusting relationships
- 1. Results: Enables leaders to set the standard
- 1. Efficiency: Addresses small challenges early to avoid major mistakes later
- 1. DIB: Creates a safe work environment
- 1. Iteration: Motivates people and establishes a growth mindset
- 1. Transparency: Keeps teams aware of team strengths and challenges

Feedback can come in the form of "praise" for things team members do well, and "tips" pertaining to improvement areas. We encourage sharing and documenting both types of feedback on a regular basis via:

- 1. 360 Feedback via Culture Amp
 - 1. Regularly during 1-1's
 - 1. "365 feedback": Giving verbal, direct feedback 365 days a year in the thanks Slack channel, direct message, or other personal communication

Documenting Feedback

Why it's important to document:

- 1. Ensures both giver and receiver are on the same page; No Surprises!
- 1. Provides focus and helps track progress
- 1. Lays the ground for self reflections and performance discussions
- 1. Supports decision making

Impact

Feedback conversations are core to personal and professional growth. According to research conducted by TruQu:

- 1. Constructive and timely feedback can improve performance up to 39%
- 1. When people receive appreciative feedback or recognition, they are 69% more motivated to deliver high performance
- 1. 4/10 employees are actively disengaged when they get little or no feedback
- 1. When we engage in and document feedback more frequently, we reduce the anxiety of feedback and reduce the potential for "surprises"

Guidance on Giving and Receiving Feedback

Embracing Feedback

"In teamwork, silence isn't golden, it's deadly." ~Mark Sanborn

The habit of seeking feedback may not be easy to develop, but failing to seek honest input from your team can have a significant impact on GitLab's culture. Patrick Lencioni, author of *The Five Dysfunctions of a Team* (2002), cites these consequences of ignoring feedback:

- 1. Inattention to Results
- 1. Avoidance of Accountability
- 1. Lack of Commitment
- 1. Fear of Conflict
- 1. Absence of Trust

Watch as Dr. Jeb Hurley, Co-founder of Xmetryx, analyzes why leaders choose to avoid feedback, even when they have ample evidence that shows its benefits.

{{< vimeo "546933765" >}}

Hard Conversations

Difficult and constructive feedback is valuable when delivered with compassion. It's important to consider the individual receiving the feedback and anticipate how they might react. As explained in *Crucial Conversations*, if the person feels threatened, they might shift into Silence or Verbal Violence.

To optimize for a open, honest, and effective conversation, reflection on the following before sharing difficult feedback:

- 1. What do I really want for myself?
- 1. What do I really want for the other(s)?
- 1. What do I really want for the relationship?
- 1. How would I behave if I really wanted these results?

Preparing for hard conversations is important, tips in this article about using mediation techniques can help you prepare to have these conversations in an authentic and honest manner.

Radical candor

Radical Candor is a framework about HOW to deliver feedback. It's a powerful, assertive, and caring place that demonstrates to an individual that you both care about them personally and that you're willing to challenge them directly. When you're not caring personally or challenging directly, it can lead to Ruinous Empathy, Manipulative Insincerity, or Obnoxious Aggression.

- Radical Candor · The Surprising Secret to Being a Good Boss First Round Review
- How To Use Radical Candor To Drive Great Results
- Brutal Honesty and Radical Candor: 6 Ways You're Getting Radical Candor Wrong and 6 Ways to Get It Right

Cross-Cultural Feedback Considerations

GitLab has 2000+ team members from diverse cultures and backgrounds. We should get to know our team members well enough to understand how best to share feedback. It's important to adapt tone and style according to each individual and relationship. Consider:

1. Do you need to build relationship before candor is comfortable?
1. Consider comfort with direct vs indirect feedback
1. Is their communication generally explicit or implicit?
1. Influence of hierarchy in direct feedback?

What Comes First, Honesty or Trust?

It's safer to give and receive feedback from those with whom you have already established trust. Trust makes it easier to assume good intent and to be boldly honest with each other.

| Strategy for Building Trust | Description |

| ----- | ----- |

| Start with task based trust | Giving feedback can build trust. Start with task based feedback, like sharing a typo in something they have written. Starting with the task based feedback can lead to more transformational behavior feedback. |

| Build relational trust | Trust enables safety and productive conversations about feedback.

Review the [building trust handbook page]/handbook/leadership/building-trust/) for guidance. |

| Be candid | Being candid builds trust. Willingness to give feedback shows honesty. |

Giving Feedback

1. Have positive intent
 - If you have the intent to hurt someone and not to help them, reconsider giving the feedback.
 - Harsh feedback does not help people thrive and excel.
1. Make it a frequent event and do it in real time
 - Don't wait until performance reviews to deliver
1. Avoid using absolutes
 - For Example: "You always." "You never show up to meetings on time."

1. Feedback should be both positive and constructive
 - It is recommended to use a 4:1 ratio of positive to constructive
1. Use the Situation-Behavior-Impact (S-B-I) Model
1. Allow the feedback receiver time to reflect
1. Focus on the root cause
 - What are the behaviors you've experienced?
 - What would improve the relationship between you and the other person/ team?
1. Understand the impact
 - What is the effect/impact of the behaviors on you/others (positive or negative)?
 - How is the behavior not aligned with GitLab's values?
 - What are the cost/benefits to the person or team?
1. Focus on actions and outcomes
 - What actions can be taken after getting feedback?
1. Recognize how communication styles differ
 - Could the individual's background affect the way they prefer to receive feedback?
 - Read The Culture Map to understand communication and feedback styles of different countries.

S-B-I Model

The Situation-Behavior-Impact (S-B-I) Model focuses feedback based on:

Situation - Define the when and where by anchoring in time and place.

Behavior - Describe the observable behavior and how it was applied.

Impact - Describe how the other person's action affected you or others experiences and thinking.

For a more in-depth look at how to apply this model see The Situation-Behavior-Impact-Feedback Framework, an external blog post that has a bit more detail and some examples.

Receiving Feedback

Receiving all types of feedback can be difficult. Our brains want to protect us from any potential dangers, and receiving feedback can be perceived as a physical threat. We have outlined some guidelines and tips to help with this:

1. Assume positive intent
 - This is likely uncomfortable for the feedback giver as well
1. Be an active listener
 - This is hard because our brains want us to run away
 - Slow down and really take the time to listen to what the other person is saying so you can reflect on it
1. Be respectful
 - Give them your full attention
1. Ask questions
 - It's okay to take time to reflect on it and then come back with questions at a later time
1. Show appreciation
 - Say thank you and mean it

1. Reflect on the feedback

- Take time to reflect on what you have heard and then think about the action
- Pitfall: Over-engineering or overdoing the response

1. Make a decision

- What are the most impactful actions you can take - prioritize
- Who has what responsibility in follow up (i.e. giver/receiver)? Both.

Recognition

While not always immediately thought of as a form of feedback, recognition is one of the most essential forms of providing feedback in the workplace.

How To Recognize Team Members

It's important to be precise about both team member's accomplishment and the impact of their accomplishment.

Example:

General Feedback:

"Thank you for helping troubleshoot sessions on XYZ tickets so we could resolve them inside the SLA."

Precise Feedback That Includes impact:

"Thank you for helping troubleshoot sessions on XYZ tickets so we could resolve them inside the SLA. This helps keep customers happy with our solutions and shows our team how to resolve similar issues faster in the future."

When and Where to Give Recognition

When:

1. Team member is excelling with respect to CREDIT
1. Team member has gone through a significant challenge and remained transparent in explaining those challenges
1. Team member completes a high impact Epic / Issue either quickly or that they worked on over multiple releases.
1. Team member has recently undergone a reorganization.
1. Any impactful Security / Quality achievement
1. Engagement with a Community Contributor

Where:

1. Post a message in the thanks channel for team member recognition
1. Share an update of the team member(s) recognition during the next team meeting
1. Highlight the recognition of the team members during a group conversation with the broader organization
1. Showcase the recognition during an e-group meeting to executives

1. Consider a discretionary bonus per team member as a form of superior recognition
1. Managers can also recognize team members during 1-1 meetings
1. Quarterly Skip Level Meetings.

Managers should consider their team member's preference for how to receive recognition when choosing what forum seems the most appropriate.

Beware Of Saying "Thank You" Too Much

Take a moment to identify situations in which you or your team are saying "Thank You" to the same person or team too often. Recognition is essential, but if it becomes very frequent, it can start to be perceived as less sincere. If the same team member or team is going above and beyond their job responsibility on a regular basis, the best way to say thank you is to recognize this pattern of overachievement.

Additional Resources

- Your Employees Want the Negative Feedback you hate to Give
- Principles of Charity
- Difficult Conversations: How to Discuss What Matters Most
- The Culture Map
- On 2018-02-15, we recorded a training on Peer to Peer Feedback
- Hofstede Country Comparison Tool
- Kim Malone Scott speaking about Radical Candor - The Surprising Secret to being a good Boss
- Radical Candor and giving constructive feedback
- Giving and Receiving Feedback - a 28 minute LinkedIn Learning course by Dr. Gemma Lee Roberts
- Coaching Feedback Model
- COIN & COILED feedback models - World of Work Project Article, 3 minute LinkedIn Learning video on COIN.
- CEDAR Feedback model - introduction and overview from join.com, and a more comprehensive article and sample conversation at World of Work Project

Modeling a Culture of Feedback Manager Competency

In an all-remote organization, people managers model a culture of feedback that promotes ongoing feedback that happens throughout the year. Feedback should not wait until performance evaluations, it should happen throughout the year - anytime and in real-time. People managers can develop their team members through positive and constructive forms of feedback.

Skills and behavior of the modeling a culture of feedback manager competency:

- Solicits and is open to feedback
- Promotes a culture of ongoing feedback that occurs any time of year and is done in real-time
- Creates a welcoming environment for feedback and enables team members to value open discussions and debates where they continually learn from one another
- Turns challenges into learning opportunities
- Champions a team environment where feedback occurs all the time and is not done once or twice a year during performance review cycles

SECTION: people-group/incident-response.md

Incident Response Plan

When an extreme weather event; natural disaster or any other catastrophe occurs in a location that is near the location of a team member, People Connect will send a notification email to all relevant team members and their manager, using the template found in the People Group project as a guideline - all communications must be reviewed and approved by leadership and in certain instances will be released by a member of the executive group.

When to initiate Incident Response

A catastrophic event has the potential to pose a significant threat to human health and safety, property, critical infrastructures and national security.

These events may come without any warning and/or they could be driven by seasonal weather patterns. Different countries around the world have various ways of declaring a disaster e.g. The Office of Disaster Management in India is responsible for declaring and directing efforts around Natural Disasters whereas the United States of America the Department of Homeland Security would initiate these declarations and the associated federal response.

Team Member Assistance

GitLab reimburses ground transport to all team members to get out of the location they are in, via a vendor of choice e.g.: Uber/ Taxify/ Lyft/ Via etc. to a safe location. Team members should use Navan Expense for all reimbursements.

Time Off From Work

Team members should focus on the safety of their families and themselves first and leverage GitLab's time off policy. Your manager may contact you on a relatively frequent basis while you are out, just to ensure you have everything you need during this time.

Team member resources

We understand that these events can be extremely stressful for team members and their families. We encourage all team members to utilize our Modern Health services. Modern Health is a company-sponsored, confidential and free resource available to you and your dependents. Services include confidential counseling, financial information and resources, legal support and more. Please refer to our Modern Health page in the handbook for more details.

If you have any questions about team member benefits coverage, please contact our total rewards team at HelpLab.

Actions to take as a Manager

As a manager, when you receive a notification of a team member on your team that is possibly affected by a disaster or weather event, we recommend the following steps:

1. Talk to your team member(s) after receiving the email. Take the time to listen: What are their concerns and their needs?
1. Make them aware of our flexible work policy and PTO policy
1. Point them to our Employee Assistance Program, Modern Health
1. GitLab has established a Team Member Relief Program to assist with financial hardship from disasters or other emergencies. Please ask them to visit the GitLab Cares Portal to easily determine if they're eligible for program assistance and to apply for assistance.
1. If the team member wants to consider a permanent relocation as a result of being in an unsafe environment direct them to our process for Dutch Work Permits. We have a special consideration for team members in unsafe environments.
1. Reference this Incident Response Page

SECTION: people-group/organizational-change-management.md

Introduction

GitLab is growing fast and we have been ranked as one of the fastest-growing private software companies. Headcount has nearly doubled in the last year and we have plans to continue to grow. As we scale, there will be more and more changes to how we operate as an organization. New technology will be introduced to make us more efficient, new processes will be introduced to improve transparency, functional groups will be redesigned and adjusted to meet our growing headcount and strategic objectives, job families will change, and policies in the handbook will be altered that have a big impact on how we operate.

As we evolve, there is a need to implement organizational change management (OCM) processes and methodologies to ensure impacted team members are enabled with the knowledge, leadership, coaching, and training they need to adapt successfully. This handbook page will walk through a step-by-step approach to OCM within GitLab. People leaders and individual contributors can use this page when structuring an organizational change management process and campaign.

What is Organizational Change Management (OCM)

Change Management has traditionally referred to the processes, procedures, tools, and techniques applied in IT environments to carefully manage changes in an operational environment. In our context, OCM refers to the actions in which a company or business alters a major component of its organization, such as its culture, technology, people, process, or policies it uses to operate. OCM is the method of leveraging change to bring about a successful resolution, and it typically includes a systematic methodology to support a transformational journey.

When to use OCM at GitLab

At GitLab, there are many use cases for applying an OCM process. Consider it a methodology to apply when rolling out major initiatives that impact our people and ways of working. The methodology does not have to apply to every new initiative but it should be considered.

Examples of when to use OCM include:

- Adoption of a new technology that all team members will use (i.e. Integrating the Learning Management System, etc.)
- Implementing a new succession planning process (i.e. Performance/Potential Matrix)
- Rolling out a 360 review process for all team members to use
- Updating our total rewards policies (i.e. updating our compensation calculator, iterating on benefits plans, etc.)
- Changing a hot button policy (i.e. discretionary bonus criteria requiring additional requirements, changes to compensation plans)
- Implementing a new system or tool for all team members that some may see as contentious (i.e. Endpoint Management software, etc.)
- Enabling team members to effectively use new tools to improve their job at the time of release (i.e. Culture AMP, Learning Management System, etc.)
- Significant team restructures
- Other examples

There are varying levels of the OCM process that can be implemented to facilitate the change. The above is a small example of the type of organization-wide initiatives that we can consider applying the OCM methodology. Keep in mind that some transformations require less OCM, while major changes require a heavy focus on OCM. Consider if they change will impact the whole organization. If it will, the DRI can review the OCM methodology to ensure the change lands successfully.

Not every change project at GitLab requires the full OCM methodology to be applied. Consider applying OCM when there are major people, processes, technology, and policy changes that impact our team member's ways of working.

Examples of when not to apply the OCM methodology:

- Announcing a new GitLab feature
- Communicating executive-level updates that come directly from leadership
- Implementing an iterative change that has a track record of iteration and team member input
- Updating and communicating changes to the Handbook
- Providing awareness and generating excitement for a company-wide initiative (i.e. Family and Friends Day, etc.)
- Announcing and implementing a company-wide initiative (i.e. Direct messages in Slack, internal comms campaign, etc.)
- Training team members on new skills, business/technical acumen, etc
- Much more!

Why is OCM important

Organizational change is necessary for GitLab to succeed and grow. OCM drives the successful adoption and usage of change within the business. It allows team members to understand and commit to the shift and work effectively during it. Without effective OCM, GitLab transitions can be rocky and expensive in terms of both time and resources. Ultimately, a lack of OCM can lead to important initiatives to not take off or fail after the introduction.

GitLab OCM methodology

We are going to define an OCM process that aligns with our values, organizational structure,

and ways of working. Consider applying aspects of the methodology to change initiatives. The methodology does not have to be applied formally but components of it can be considered and reviewed before rolling out change initiatives.

Key components of GitLab's OCM methodology:

1. Develop an agile change plan
1. Assess the impact
1. Analyze team member engagement
1. Communicate the change
1. Train for the change
1. Measure and adopt the change

Step 1 - Develop an agile change plan

When rolling out an organization-wide change that will impact all team members, the first step is to develop an agile change plan. An agile change plan can be informal and the DRI for the change can do it asynchronously with others leading the change. You can draft the plan in a Google doc and use it as a starting point when planning for change. For OCM to work, it's essential to have all the components documented as a source of record and plan for the change.

When developing the agile change plan, there are a few important components to consider:

1. Leadership Engagement: Visible leadership is the key to success on any large scale transformations at GitLab. Team members will be looking to leaders for cues on how to interpret the change and what actions to take. Depending on the scale of the change, its success will depend on leaders effectively sponsoring and ensuring readiness within their functional groups.
 - Leadership will drive team member engagement and adoption of the change
1. Leadership awareness and engagement plan: As you start to develop an understanding of how to drive team member engagement with leaders, consider plotting out awareness activities you will do with leaders to get them bought in on the change. Communicate what you will do and why you need their support to drive adoption.
1. Include all other components of the GitLab OCM methodology to your change plan:
 - Impact assessment
 - Team member engagement analysis
 - Communication plan
 - Training plan
 - Measurement and adoption

Step 2 - Assess the impact

Before rolling out the change, consider measuring the impact. Depending on the severity, it is important to understand the current state before communicating the future state. Document the impacts in your agile change plan. It's important to consider all of the potential impacts to mitigate disruptions to team member's day-to-day work. Some key questions to answer when assessing the impact of the change:

- What's the history behind this transformation?
- Has GitLab tried to do this before?
- Were previous changes successful? If not, why weren't they?

- Have similar changes been well received?
- What is the current process outlined in the Handbook?
- How will the new change impact team members' ways of working?
- Other impacts to consider

Step 3 - Analyze team member engagement

With any major change, it is essential to identify which groups within the organization that will be impacted. In this step, we can determine who will be impacted and identify mitigation strategies to ensure minimal disruption to their day-to-day work.

After you have completed the impact assessment, you can determine which groups of people in the organization will be impacted the most by the change. For example, 360 reviews will require significant manager time and dedication. Managers are the most impacted by the reviews, especially if they have a high number of direct reports. When rolling out the 360 reviews, managers should be the target audience to cascade information down to their teams.

When rolling out a new initiative, consider who in the organization will be the most impacted.

This is also a good time to identify champions within the impacted groups that can help serve as positive change agents throughout the remainder of the OCM process. Champions can help "message test" the change before you send it out to the wider audience, and they can serve as advocates and subject matter experts for the change in their day-to-day work once the change is announced. Champions can include members of leadership, but they should also include team members from all varieties of organizational levels to ensure that you have access to feedback and perceived impact at all levels, allowing you to more effectively craft your communications.

Step 4 - Communicating the change

Once you've understood the impacts and who will be most impacted, start developing a communication plan. Analyzing team member engagement and impacts can help guide and engage team members through the change program. Communications should be updated per feedback from all team members to ensure that everyone has an opportunity to contribute before a change is finalized. The timing of communications can also be different based on the impact analysis and who are the most impacted audience groups. And, depending on the impact of the change, you might want to consider giving managers talking points/guidance that they can use to discuss the changes 1:1 with their team to answer questions and/or address concerns.

Focus on delivering the right amount of detail to the right audience, through the right communications channel, and at the right time. We typically rely on Slack channels to send organization-wide communications. Leverage the channels that will provide the most impact to ensure leaders and team members can articulate with clarity and purpose of the change project.

The goal of this step is to build the credibility of the project and clearly articulate what it will deliver as well as the ideal end-state. It can also help generate a positive perception of the transformation.

Key Activities:

- Communication plan: identify what, when, and to whom

- Key messages outlined in an Issue or Google Doc
- Communication materials: Slack messages that direct team members to Issues for feedback and a historical record, handbook page links, templates, videos, AMA meeting, manager talking points, etc.

Step 5 - Train for the change

Training for the change should include both traditional and informal methods to address the needs of varied audiences. Relevant content can be developed to support team members who will be most impacted and the specific project requirements. Training materials can include slide decks, handbook pages, explainer videos, job-aides, tutorials, etc. Training can also be delivered through live learning and recordings that walk team members through the transformation.

Research shows that a blend of the types of training below is the most effective to achieve successful knowledge retention and skill internalization. Per the GitLab 70-20-10 training approach, the majority of the training will focus on where 70% of learning occurs - learning all the time resources, 20% occurs when learning from others, and 10% via traditional instruction. Consider holding a traditional/formal training event for the type of transformation that is taking place.

GitLab Learner Experience - 70-20-10 Training approach:

```
<figure class="videocontainer">
<iframe src="https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/e/2PACX-
1vTivHwhC9pzPirV2tZxi6TGhGHfFTVw7Xr0NieqPlxLi7UDvbG6AUAPAQYeueeRSsftVtPWHkLsQjO/embed
e&loop=false&delayms=3000" frameborder="0" width="960" height="569" allowfullscreen="true"
mozallowfullscreen="true" webkitallowfullscreen="true"></iframe>
</figure>
```

Step 6 - Measure and adopt the change

The ultimate purpose of the OCM process is to get team members to adopt the change and implement it in their day-to-day role. To ensure this, it is important to focus on user adoption and measure it regularly so we can adjust the communications and training approach. Apply iteration to the change by consistently looking for new ways to roll out programs more efficiently. If appropriate, consider opening an issue to allow for team members to provide feedback which will inform future iterations.

To drive the adoption and usage of new changes, it is essential to provide proper metrics and measurement tools. A successful adoption helps in mitigating the organizational challenges and realizing business benefits to ensure better ROI and a successful sustained transformation.

Step 7 - Close the feedback loop

Part of successful OCM is creating a positive experience and sentiment for team members around large organizational changes - meaning, team members feel that their feedback was heard, and they understand the positive impact of the change. This means that communication should not stop abruptly once the change is made. Instead, it is crucial for you to "close the feedback loop" by clearly communicating the metrics from the steps above as well as providing insight

into how the organization has benefited (and is expected to continue benefiting) from the change that has been made.

A Manager's role in OCM

Within GitLab, every team member has a different role in assisting with change. Leaders, for example, have to be courageous by taking on risks. They can look at the big picture and articulate high-level changes to the organization, explain why it is occurring, and motivate team members to support the transition.

Managers can be more concentrated on making business transitions successful. They focus on implementing change by determining the discrete steps that need to happen and their sequence. It is the primary responsibility of a manager to know how to design, direct, and shape change processes while advocating for its support. By learning how to preempt and address the challenges associated with change, managers can ensure they are equipped with the skills and knowledge needed to manage it.

Preparing for OCM at GitLab

To prepare for GitLab transformations/changes, first, define the goal of the organizational change, understand why it is critical, and garner support from team members. Then, use the OCM methodology laid out on the page to begin designing and delivering the OCM process. Ensure the methodology aligns with the goals. Note what challenges may arise and be flexible enough to adjust accordingly. Be sure to celebrate small victories along the way!

OCM doesn't stop once you've successfully executed the transition. Both throughout and following the OCM process, you need to continuously assess outcomes, measure data, train employees on new methodologies and business practices, and readjust goals as necessary to increase adoption.

Please contact the Learning & Development team if you would like more of an understanding of OCM and how to apply the methodology to a change/transformation at GitLab!

Additional Resources on Organizational Change Management

- Change Management Primer (Slides) (Video) from our Field Enablement Team
- Prosci change management resources
- Harvard Business Review Change Management Resources
- Five Levers of Change Management (article)
- Keys to Prepare for Change
- Understanding Resistance to Change

SECTION: people-group/orientation-identity.md

The content on this page is inspired by other sites with glossaries and FAQs. It should be noted that many LGBTQ+ terms don't have complete alignment and can have different meanings and nuance in different communities. This is a glossary of terms with some broadly accepted definitions.

The reasons for creating a Gender and Sexual Orientation Identity page in the GitLab handbook:

1. Many organizations, including the HRC, have put careful thought and effort into how these delicate concepts can be explained with clarity, fairness, and respect. At GitLab we should leverage this work.

1. Adding it as readable content rather than directing to a new website means this information is searchable within the handbook for folks who are looking for answers as well as making sections directly linkable from elsewhere in the handbook, in issues, slack, etc.

1. GitLab has employees from around the globe, where the language used may be different. This gives all employees the opportunity to establish a common language framework to help create a healthy, supportive, and inclusive environment.

Additional resources

- GitLab Ally Resources
- Diversity, Inclusion and Belonging at GitLab
- Human Rights Campaign website
 - HRC Sexual Orientation and Gender Identity Definitions
 - HRC Transgender FAQ
- The Genderbread Person
- A comprehensive list of LGBTQ+ term definitions
- We Are Family Lesbian, Gay and Bisexual Glossary of Terms
- UC Davis LGBTQIA Resource Center Glossary
- Things not to say to a trans person

Definitions

Gender identity

A person's internal perception of their own gender and the words they use to label themselves. A person may identify as a woman, or a man, a blend of the two (keep reading for more information on this), or neither. A person's gender identity may or may not be the same as their sex assigned at birth.

In our HRIS (Human Resource Information System) Workday, we have two self-identification fields related to Gender, which we ask our team members to complete during the onboarding process, although it is completely optional. We have one Gender field with only two options. This field is a default field in the HRIS and is not inclusive due to the fact that it is primarily used for mandatory Governmental reports and data classification.

At GitLab, we have the additional Other Gender Options field, which currently has a number of options for our team members to choose if you would like to. If you would like an additional option added, please contact our DIB team at diversityinclusion@gitlab.com. We are transparent in our results in our anonymous Identity Data.

Gender expression

A person's external display of their gender identity through clothing, grooming, behavior, etc. Gender expression commonly falls on a spectrum between feminine, androgynous, and masculine.

Cisgender

Cisgender or cis, refers to a person whose gender identity and/or expression generally aligns with the typical expectations of their sex assigned at birth.

Assigned Female/Male at Birth (AFAB, AMAB)

Sex Assignment is the determination of an infant's sex at birth. All babies are assigned a sex at birth which is generally directly related to their anatomy.

However, there are a variety of situations in which an individual may be assigned a certain sex but develop differing physical characteristics as they age.

Being assigned female/male at birth sets an expectation of the associated socially accepted gender expression. As mentioned above, cisgender is when a person's gender and assigned sex are the same.

The terms AFAB/AMAB are often used by people to communicate about their gender identity without reinforcing the typical views on sex.

Transgender

Transgender or "trans", is an umbrella term for people whose gender identity and/or expression generally differs from typical expectations of their sex assigned at birth. For example, along with trans men and trans women, people who identify genderqueer, non-binary, or genderfluid can be also identified as transgender. Transgender people may or may not choose to alter their bodies hormonally and/or surgically.

There are many people who choose to socially identify as transgender, or "trans" and it is a big part of who they are. Many people are transgender and choose to keep it hidden, as they want to be known as the gender they feel most comfortable with.

Some people may be visibly transgender. It is important that you do not address them by the gender and pronouns you think they are based on physical appearance. If you are not sure, use gender-neutral pronouns (they/them).

Trans man

An identity that describes a man who was assigned a female gender at birth. The term female-to-male transgender, abbreviated as FTM or F2M, is also used by some transgender people.

Trans woman

An identity that describes a woman who was assigned a male gender at birth. The term male-to-female transgender, abbreviated as MTF or M2F, is also used by some transge